TAUSIF ATTAR
35, Nashik

Another team leader, allegedly blackmailed and demanded sexual favours from a victim, is also charged with inappropriately touching women, making obscene remarks



RAZA MEMON
35, Nashik

Alleged to have made suggestive remarks to a married woman, offering her "help" while her husband was away; misbehaved with another woman as well

SHAFI SHEIKH
35, Nashik

Accused of making obscene remarks and staring at women colleagues, making them uncomfortable

SHAHRUKH QURESHI
35, Nashik

Allegedly made indecent comments on women's attire, touched them inappropriately, repeatedly questioned a woman about the nature of her relationship with her husband

ASIF ANSARI
22, Nashik

Allegedly touched women colleagues inappropriately, derided Hindu deities

ASHWINI CHAINANI
51, Pune

Assistant general manager, operations, and POSH committee member based in Pune, allegedly ignored verbal complaints against the accused, "instructed" the Nashik unit manager to give them good appraisals

NIDA KHAN
25, Bhiwandi

A process associate, accused of "brain-washing" women, acting as an intermediary between them and the abusers. On the run, she has filed for anticipatory bail

FIRs have been registered under the following BNS sections

- **Section 69** (sexual intercourse with woman by deceitful means/ making false promise to marry)
- **Section 75** (sexual harassment)
- **Section 78** (stalking)
- **Section 79** (word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman)
- **Section 356** (defamation)
- **Section 299** (deliberate and malicious acts to outrage religious feelings)
- **Section 49** (abetment to a crime)

home out of alleged concern, helping build rapport with families. Nida, too, is alleged to have befriended the young female employees, and was said to be the link between them and the senior colleagues. "Many of these women were young, around 20, and responded to what seemed like care and protection," says a former employee.

Once emotional dependence set in, coercion followed, say the investigators. It allegedly took the shape of rewards and punishments. Women who complied with their demands were granted informal privileges such as lenient office timings. Those who resisted allegedly faced subtle penalties, like being marked late even for minor delays or, as one FIR mentions, having excessive customer calls routed to them.

Outside the office, the city of Nashik, with its cool climate, surrounding hills and secluded stretches, apparently became an unwitting backdrop. Danish, states Vaishnavi's FIR, took her to places such as Khandoba Tekdi, resorts along Trimbakeshwar Road and the quiet, tree-lined stretches of Devlali Camp, where their 'romance' blossomed. Social interactions like movie outings, impromptu weekend plans and biryani lunches were said to be common among the staffers. Police are also examining claims that food or drinks may have been laced with substances.

Inside the office, team leaders were allegedly given wide freedom in dealing with their teams. Employees allege that the pattern of favouritism was difficult to miss. "Official working hours were nine, but some would log in and leave within three hours," says a former employee. "They would offer namaaz in office multiple times a day and even pressure others to follow." Complaints raised by a unit manager—via emails and performance appraisals—were allegedly dismissed. "Whenever he gave them poor ratings, he was instructed to award them the highest scores, so he had to change them from D to A," adds the former employee.

SILENCE OF THE LAMBS?

How did this alleged conspiracy continue for three long years? There was apparently no way to document the alleged harassment—bags and mobile phones were mandated to be left outside. Warnings and complaints, several employees allege, were repeatedly ignored. Under fire is Ashwini, the operations AGM, who was with the organisation for over two decades and was part of the POSH (prevention of sexual harassment) committee that operated from Pune. (The Nashik unit did not have a POSH